
CHECKLIST

AI Content Review Checklist

A pre-publication review for accuracy, context, originality, brand voice, claims, sources, disclosure, and human judgment.

Pulse Analytics Group LLC

Free Resources Library

AI can help produce a draft. It cannot remove the need to review the draft.

Use this checklist for AI-assisted or AI-generated website copy, blog posts, emails, social posts, ads, product descriptions, reports, scripts, and other marketing content. The amount of review should match the consequences of being wrong.

Do not treat a detector score as a substitute for editorial review. Check the actual content: its claims, sources, context, originality, tone, and usefulness to the intended reader.

Content record

Asset / title	
Channel	☐ Website ☐ Blog ☐ Email ☐ Social ☐ Ad ☐ Product ☐ Other
Reviewer	
Date	
AI involvement	☐ Research ☐ Outline ☐ Draft ☐ Rewrite ☐ Image/video ☐ Analysis ☐ Other
Publication status	☐ Approved ☐ Revise ☐ Hold ☐ Reject

1. Accuracy and factual review

☐ Every material factual claim can be traced to a reliable source or first-hand evidence.

Verify: Open the source and confirm the claim actually supports the wording used.

Why it matters: A source that discusses a topic is not automatically evidence for every statement about it.

Common problem: Citing a general article while making a more specific claim than the source supports.

☐ Names, dates, numbers, prices, product details, features, and specifications are current.

Verify: Check against the current primary source where the detail matters.

Why it matters: These are common places for plausible but incorrect AI output.

Common problem: Keeping an old number because it sounds reasonable.

☐ The draft does not invent studies, statistics, customer results, quotes, credentials, or citations.

Verify: Verify every citation, quotation, and numerical claim.

Why it matters: Fabricated support can create reputational and legal problems.

Common problem: Assuming a citation exists because the AI supplied a URL or publication name.

☐ Uncertainty is represented honestly.

Verify: Add qualifiers where the evidence is incomplete, disputed, estimated, or time-sensitive.

Why it matters: Readers need to know the difference between a fact and an inference.

Common problem: Turning an estimate into a precise statement.

2. Context and meaning

☐ The content answers the reader's actual question or need.

Verify: Read it as the intended audience, not as the person who wrote the prompt.

Why it matters: AI can produce fluent material that misses the practical question.

Common problem: Optimizing for polished wording instead of usefulness.

☐ Important limitations and exceptions are included.

Verify: Ask what a reasonable reader could misunderstand if they only read this page.

Why it matters: Omitting a material limitation can change the meaning of a claim.

Common problem: Presenting a feature without explaining a meaningful restriction.

☐ Examples match the subject and audience.

Verify: Confirm examples are realistic and do not accidentally imply a guarantee.

Why it matters: Generic examples can mislead when applied to a specific industry.

Common problem: Using an invented case study as though it were a real customer result.

☐ The content distinguishes facts, recommendations, opinions, and assumptions.

Verify: Label or rewrite statements where the category is unclear.

Why it matters: Different types of statements require different support.

Common problem: Presenting a recommendation as if it were an objective fact.

3. Originality and usefulness

☐ The content adds something beyond a generic summary.

Verify: Identify the original insight, example, process, data, experience, or explanation.

Why it matters: Google's current guidance emphasizes helpful, original, people-first content.

Common problem: Publishing many near-identical AI pages that add little value.

☐ The draft has been checked for accidental copying or overly close phrasing.

Verify: Compare distinctive language and examples with important source material.

Why it matters: AI-assisted drafting can still produce content that is too close to another source.

Common problem: Assuming paraphrasing always makes source material sufficiently distinct.

☐ The content is organized for the reader, not for keyword coverage.

Verify: Remove sections that exist only because a prompt requested them.

Why it matters: Excess structure can make content less useful.

Common problem: Creating separate sections for every possible search variation.

☐ The content contains enough specific detail to be useful.

Verify: Ask what the reader can actually do differently after reading it.

Why it matters: A broad summary may be accurate but still not useful.

Common problem: Publishing generic advice with no practical method.

4. Brand voice and editorial quality

☐ The tone matches the brand's documented voice.

Verify: Compare the draft with approved examples.

Why it matters: A technically correct draft can still sound unlike the organization.

Common problem: Letting the AI's default style become the brand voice.

☐ The content avoids exaggerated promises and unnecessary urgency.

Verify: Replace unsupported superlatives with specific, supportable language.

Why it matters: Marketing language can turn a factual weakness into a misleading impression.

Common problem: Words such as “guaranteed,” “perfect,” or “always” without evidence.

☐ The draft has been edited by a human who understands the subject.

Verify: The reviewer should be able to explain why each important statement is there.

Why it matters: Subject-matter judgment cannot be delegated merely because the prose is polished.

Common problem: Proofreading grammar while skipping substantive review.

☐ The final copy is concise where it should be and detailed where detail matters.

Verify: Remove repetition, filler, and generic transitions.

Why it matters: AI drafts often become longer without becoming more informative.

Common problem: Keeping paragraphs because they sound professional.

5. Claims, advertising, and evidence

☐ Performance claims have evidence that supports the exact claim.

Verify: Record the evidence and its date, population, scope, and limitations.

Why it matters: The FTC states that advertising claims must be truthful, non-deceptive, and evidence-based.

Common problem: Using an AI-generated statistic as substantiation.

☐ Testimonials and endorsements are represented accurately.

Verify: Confirm the statement, relationship, and context are real and properly disclosed where required.

Why it matters: A generated testimonial is not a substitute for a real customer statement.

Common problem: Inventing a customer voice or case study.

☐ Comparative claims have a defined comparison.

Verify: Identify what is being compared, when, and using which evidence.

Why it matters: “Better,” “faster,” and similar claims need a meaningful basis.

Common problem: Comparing unlike products or time periods.

☐ AI-related product claims have been verified.

Verify: Check claims about accuracy, detection, automation, savings, or performance against current evidence.

Why it matters: The FTC has taken action concerning unsupported accuracy claims for AI detection products.

Common problem: Repeating a vendor's accuracy percentage without reviewing the basis.

6. Sources and citations

☐ Primary sources are used when available.

Verify: Prefer official documentation, original research, regulatory sources, or the actual data owner.

Why it matters: Secondary summaries can omit important qualifications.

Common problem: Citing a blog when the original policy or specification is available.

☐ Links work and point to the intended material.

Verify: Open every important link before publication.

Why it matters: Broken or mismatched links weaken trust and make verification harder.

Common problem: Copying a URL from an AI answer without checking it.

☐ Sources are recent enough for time-sensitive claims.

Verify: Check publication/update dates and whether the rule has changed.

Why it matters: Platform policies, product features, and standards change.

Common problem: Using a three-year-old article for a current platform feature.

☐ Citations support the sentence they follow.

Verify: Place citations where a reader can tell what they support.

Why it matters: A source list at the bottom can be ambiguous.

Common problem: Using one citation to imply support for unrelated claims.

7. Disclosure, provenance, and review records

☐ The team has decided whether disclosure of AI assistance is appropriate for this content.

Verify: Consider audience expectations, platform rules, contractual requirements, and the nature of the content.

Why it matters: There is no single disclosure rule that fits every marketing asset.

Common problem: Treating disclosure as either universally required or universally unnecessary.

☐ Internal records show how AI was used when that record is useful.

Verify: Record the tool, purpose, major inputs, reviewer, and approval date for higher-risk workflows.

Why it matters: A simple record can make later correction and auditing easier.

Common problem: Having no way to reconstruct how a material claim was produced.

☐ Media provenance is considered where authenticity matters.

Verify: For relevant images/video, check whether the production workflow supports provenance or Content Credentials.

Why it matters: C2PA provides a technical standard for recording verifiable content provenance.

Common problem: Assuming metadata automatically proves that content is authentic.

☐ The final published version has a named human reviewer.

Verify: Record who approved it and what level of review was performed.

Why it matters: Accountability should remain clear.

Common problem: A workflow where everyone assumes someone else checked it.

Final publication gate

Use this page after the detailed review. A “pass” should mean the reviewer has evidence, not simply a feeling that the content looks good.

Review area	Pass	Needs attention	N/A
Factual claims verified	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
Sources checked and links verified	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
Context and limitations reviewed	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
Originality and usefulness reviewed	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
Brand voice and editorial quality reviewed	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
Claims and advertising evidence reviewed	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
AI disclosure/provenance decision made where relevant	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A
Human approval recorded	■ Pass	■ Needs attention	■ N/A

Issues found / corrections required

Approval

Reviewer	_____	Date	_____
Decision	■ Approve ■ Revise ■ Hold ■ Reject	Version	_____

Sources and further reading

- FTC Advertising and Marketing Basics: <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/advertising-marketing>
- FTC Small Business Advertising FAQs: <https://www.ftc.gov/business-guidance/resources/advertising-faqs-guide-small-business>
- FTC Workado AI detection enforcement matter: <https://www.ftc.gov/legal-library/browse/cases-proceedings/2323092-content-scale-ai>
- Google Search: AI-generated content guidance: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/using-gen-ai-content>
- Google Search: Generative AI features guidance: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/ai-optimization-guide>
- C2PA Content Credentials specification: <https://spec.c2pa.org/specifications/specifications/2.4/specs/ContentCredentials.html>